

panic. My email and phone light up, reporters want a comment on the sudden surge in volatility. They don't like my answer: "This is what markets do. They go up and down, sometimes violently."

The noise subsides, markets settle down, and everyone returns to their originally scheduled programming.

One thing the perma-bears never inform you in their never-ending parade of Armageddon forecasts is that there is *always* a reason to sell stocks. The problem with those reasons is they rarely turn out to be smart, or work in the investor's favor.

Have a look at these charts my colleague Michael Batnick⁴⁰⁰ created covering all of the reasons you had to get out of equities between the GFC and Covid.

Reasons to sell



Every one of those emotional, ill-advised sales left lots of money on the table.

Or how about this chart, showing how much a dollar invested in the stock market a century ago (1926) has grown, despite myriad reasons to sell along the way.